

SOUTHERN CROSS STRATEGIC HOLDINGS PTE LIMITED

Maritime Security Division

SEA MARSHAL

FIELD STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES

Kikori Operational Area — Papua LNG Project Corridor
Gulf Province, Papua New Guinea

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How this document relates to the Policy

The Sea Marshal Security Policy (SCSH-SEC-MAR-001) sets the principles, standards and responsibilities that govern maritime and riverine security in the Kikori Operational Area — the “what” and the “why.” This document translates that Policy into the “how”: a set of numbered, repeatable field procedures that Sea Marshals, team leaders and marine operators follow to deliver those standards safely, lawfully and consistently on every task. Where any procedure below appears to conflict with the Policy or with the law of Papua New Guinea, the Policy and the law prevail and the matter is escalated to the MSC without delay.

Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Change	Author
1.0	Aug 2026	Initial issue. Field SOPs derived from Sea Marshal Security Policy v2.0 covering command and communications, pre-deployment checks, patrol, escort, boarding, use of force, incident and emergency response, community engagement and environmental protection.	MSC

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1. Purpose, Scope and How to Use These SOPs

1.1 Purpose

These Standard Operating Procedures give Sea Marshal personnel a single, consistent method for carrying out maritime and riverine security tasks in the Kikori Operational Area. They exist so that every escort, patrol, boarding and incident response is conducted the same safe, lawful and professional way, regardless of which team or shift is on task.

1.2 Scope

These SOPs apply to all Sea Marshal personnel and boarding officers; maritime security commanders, deputies, supervisors and team leaders; vessel operators, boat skippers, marine patrol crews and security escorts; Company marine support staff; and contracted partners and sub-contractors engaged in Kikori maritime and riverine logistics.

They cover sea and river escort of barges, cargo ships, fuel tankers and crew-transfer boats; patrols along the seashore, coastal zones, estuaries and the upstream Kikori River; static security at jetties, landing sites, anchorages and project marine assets; vessel boarding, search and clearance; and emergency response including search and rescue, medical evacuation and conflict mitigation.

1.3 How to use these SOPs

- Each SOP is a self-contained procedure with a purpose, a trigger, the person responsible, numbered steps and key notes.
- Follow the steps in sequence. Do not skip a step; if a step cannot be completed, stop and report to your Team Leader or the MSC.
- The Rules of Engagement (Annex A), incident timelines (Annex B), forms (Annex C) and emergency contacts (Annex D) are quick-reference tools to be carried on task.
- These SOPs never override the law of Papua New Guinea, a lawful order, or the safety of life. When in doubt, protect life first and report immediately.

1.4 Standing rules that apply to every SOP

- A radio check and communications are confirmed before any movement; loss of communications is a stop-work trigger.
- A documented risk assessment is completed before every escort and before any patrol into an area of elevated risk.
- Personal Protective Equipment, including life jackets, is worn by all personnel at all times afloat.
- Force is a last resort, used only where legal, necessary and proportionate, and non-lethal means are exhausted first.
- Every person is treated with dignity; VPSHR principles and respect for local communities apply at all times.
- Every incident is reported up the chain of command without delay and recorded on the correct form.

2. Roles and Chain of Command

Authority flows through a single, unambiguous chain of command. Every member is accountable to the person immediately above them. No member acts outside their delegated authority except where immediately necessary to protect life, in which case the action is reported at the earliest opportunity.

Role	SOP responsibilities
Director of Operations	Owns and approves the SOP framework; final escalation authority for major (Level 4) incidents.
Maritime Security Commander (MSC)	Accountable for all maritime security operations; authorises escorts, boardings and use-of-force follow-up; receives SITREPs and incident reports; orders stop-work.
Deputy MSC — Kikori Region	Day-to-day supervision of teams; approves routine risk assessments; deputises for the MSC.
Sea Marshal Team Leader	Runs the task on the water; authorises boardings; confirms risk assessment, briefings and radio checks; first reporting point for the team.
Sea Marshals / Boarding Officers	Execute patrol, escort, boarding, search and emergency procedures; apply the RoE; complete task records.
Boat Skipper / Marine Operator	Safe handling and navigation of the vessel; pre-start inspection; speed and hazard control; man-overboard manoeuvres.
Operations Room	Continuously monitors the Emergency Response Channel (ERC); logs SITREPs; triggers notifications and coordinates external authorities.

3. Standard Operating Procedures

3.1 Command, Communications and Watch

SOP-01 — Daily Watch Set-Up and Communications Check

Purpose: Confirm the team, vessel and communications are ready before any task begins.

Applies / trigger: Start of every shift, patrol or escort.

Responsible: Team Leader, supported by the Skipper and Operations Room.

Procedure

1. Muster the team; confirm every member is fit for duty, rested, and free of alcohol or drugs.
2. Confirm the tasking, patrol area or escort details and expected duration with the Deputy MSC / Operations Room.
3. Set radios: VHF marine radio with CH16 reserved for distress, safety and calling, and the designated working channel (e.g. CH77) for operational traffic.
4. Conduct a radio check with the Operations Room on both the working channel and the Emergency Response Channel (ERC); confirm satellite telephone is powered and reachable for out-of-range work.
5. Confirm the Operations Room is monitoring the ERC continuously for the duration of the task.
6. If any radio, ERC or satellite link fails and cannot be restored, treat it as a stop-work trigger — do not depart until communications are restored or the MSC authorises an alternative.
7. Record the watch set-up, personnel on task and communications result in the Watch / Patrol Log.

Key notes

- No movement without a confirmed radio check.
- CH16 is never used for routine operational chatter.

SOP-02 — Situation Reporting (SITREP) Routine

Purpose: Keep the MSC and Operations Room continuously aware of team status and activity.

Applies / trigger: Daily, and immediately after any event of note.

Responsible: Team Leader.

Procedure

1. Submit a routine SITREP to the MSC at the scheduled times each day, and at the start and end of every patrol and escort.
2. Use the standard SITREP format: time, position, activity, vessels/persons of interest, weather and sea state, status of personnel and equipment, and any concerns.
3. On any incident, transmit an immediate radio report first, then a full SITREP within 30 minutes of the event stabilising.
4. Confirm the Operations Room has logged each SITREP; if acknowledgement is not received, re-send and escalate.

Key notes

- Keep SITREPs factual, brief and free of speculation.
- A missed SITREP window is itself reportable — the Operations Room initiates a welfare check if a scheduled SITREP is overdue.

SOP-03 — Shift and Watch Handover

Purpose: Ensure nothing is lost between outgoing and incoming teams.

Applies / trigger: End of every shift or rotation of the on-water team.

Responsible: Outgoing and incoming Team Leaders.

Procedure

1. Brief the incoming Team Leader on current tasking, area status, vessels of interest, live risks and any ongoing incidents.
2. Hand over the Watch / Patrol Log, radios, ERC status, keys and sensitive documents against signature.
3. Physically confirm equipment counts and vessel serviceability with the incoming team.
4. Both Team Leaders sign the handover; the incoming Team Leader confirms readiness to the Operations Room before the outgoing team stands down.

Key notes

- No handover is complete until communications and equipment are confirmed by the incoming team.

3.2 Pre-Deployment Checks

SOP-04 — Equipment Inspection and Sign-Out

Purpose: Deploy only with complete, serviceable equipment, accounted for by name.

Applies / trigger: Before every deployment.

Responsible: Each team member; verified by the Team Leader.

Procedure

1. Draw and inspect the minimum team kit: VHF radios, binoculars, GPS devices, torches, body-worn cameras, first-aid kits, approved life jackets, boarding equipment and emergency flares.
2. Test each item for function (radios keyed, GPS acquires, torch and camera charged, flares in date).
3. Confirm any authorised weapons and ammunition are drawn strictly in accordance with PNG law and licence conditions, and logged separately.
4. Sign the Equipment Sign-Out Register for all items drawn; note any defect and quarantine unserviceable items.
5. Report any shortfall that prevents safe operation to the Team Leader before departure.

Key notes

- Body-worn cameras are checked as charged and are worn on all boardings and use-of-force events.
- Unserviceable safety or life-saving equipment is a no-go item.

SOP-05 — Vessel and Engine Pre-Start Inspection

Purpose: Confirm the vessel is safe and seaworthy before getting under way.

Applies / trigger: Daily and before every departure.

Responsible: Boat Skipper / Marine Operator.

Procedure

1. Inspect hull, engine, fuel system, steering, bilge and battery; confirm no leaks or damage.
2. Confirm fuel quantity is sufficient for the task plus a safe reserve.
3. Check life-saving appliances: life jackets for all persons, throw-lines, first-aid kit, flares and fire extinguisher present and in date.
4. Test navigation lights, horn and, where fitted, night-illumination.

5. Start and warm the engine; confirm cooling, controls and communications from the helm.
6. Record the inspection and any defect; a safety-critical defect is a no-go until rectified.

Key notes

- No vessel departs with a defective life-saving appliance or an unresolved safety-critical fault.

SOP-06 — Pre-Departure Risk Assessment

Purpose: Identify and control the risks of the specific task before committing to it.

Applies / trigger: Before every escort and before any patrol into an area of elevated risk.

Responsible: Team Leader (approved by Deputy MSC / MSC for elevated-risk tasks).

Procedure

1. Identify the route, choke points, river bends, narrow channels, anchorages and known crime hotspots for the task.
2. Assess the current threat picture: armed robbery at anchorage, theft, unauthorised boarding, sabotage, and community blockade or landowner interference.
3. Assess navigational and environmental hazards: shifting channels, sandbars, submerged debris, tidal flow, visibility, weather and sea state.
4. Record controls for each risk (route timing, escort composition, joint tasking, standoff distances, contingency plans).
5. Determine the residual risk. If it cannot be reduced to an acceptable level, postpone the task and escalate to the MSC.
6. Brief the assessment to the team; treat it as a living document and revise it whenever conditions change.

Key notes

- The risk assessment is the authority to proceed — no escort departs without a completed and briefed assessment.

SOP-07 — Weather and Sea-State Go / No-Go

Purpose: Prevent departure into unsafe conditions.

Applies / trigger: Before every patrol and escort.

Responsible: Skipper and Team Leader jointly.

Procedure

1. Obtain the current and forecast weather, tide and sea state for the Gulf of Papua and the river reach in use.
2. Compare conditions against the vessel's safe operating limits and the task profile.
3. Apply the Go / No-Go decision: if conditions exceed safe limits or are deteriorating, do not depart.
4. Record the assessment; where a task is already under way and conditions deteriorate, seek shelter and report to the Operations Room.

Key notes

- No patrol or escort proceeds without a current weather and sea-state assessment.

3.3 Patrol Operations

SOP-08 — Routine Patrol

Purpose: Provide visible, lawful deterrence and maintain area familiarity and situational awareness.

Applies / trigger: Scheduled daily patrols of the seashore perimeter, upstream checkpoints, hotspots, anchorages and supply routes.

Responsible: Patrol Team Leader and crew.

Procedure

1. Complete SOP-01 (watch set-up), SOP-04/05 (equipment and vessel), and the risk and weather checks.
2. Depart on the planned route; maintain a continuous 360-degree watch and log positions and times.
3. Observe and record vessels, persons and activity of interest; do not interfere with lawful traffic or communities.
4. Enforce safe speed in narrow channels and near communities; respect fishing grounds and protected areas.
5. Report status by SITREP at the scheduled points; report anything unusual immediately.
6. On completion, return, debrief, record observations and hand equipment back per SOP-04.

Key notes

- Patrols deter through lawful presence — not through confrontation.

SOP-09 — Rapid-Response Patrol

Purpose: React quickly and proportionately to an incident, alarm or intelligence indicator.

Applies / trigger: On tasking by the MSC / Operations Room in response to a trigger.

Responsible: Nominated response team.

Procedure

1. Acknowledge the tasking; confirm the nature, location and known details of the trigger.
2. Conduct a rapid risk assessment (abbreviated SOP-06) and confirm communications and the RoE brief.
3. Proceed by the safest fast route; keep the Operations Room updated with position and intentions throughout.
4. On scene, establish a safe standoff, assess, and act within the RoE (Annex A); prioritise protection of life.
5. Request joint support (SOP-10), SAR (SOP-19) or medical response (SOP-20) as the situation requires.
6. Stabilise, report a SITREP within 30 minutes, and complete the incident report per SOP-17.

Key notes

- Speed never overrides the risk assessment or the RoE.

SOP-10 — Joint Patrol with PNG Security Forces / NMSA

Purpose: Conduct lawfully coordinated joint operations where required.

Applies / trigger: When joint tasking with PNG security forces or the NMSA is authorised.

Responsible: Team Leader under MSC authorisation.

Procedure

1. Confirm the joint task is authorised and lawfully coordinated by the MSC before deploying.
2. Agree command arrangements, communications, call-signs, boundaries and the RoE with the partner force in a joint brief.
3. Operate strictly within Company authority and the agreed plan; do not assume powers the Company does not hold.

4. Maintain a separate Company log of the joint activity and report by SITREP.
5. Debrief jointly; record outcomes and any lessons; refer follow-up to the MSC.

Key notes

- Sea Marshals support and coordinate with lawful authority; they do not exceed their own legal mandate.

3.4 Vessel Escort Operations

SOP-11 — Escort — Pre-Departure and Onboarding Brief

Purpose: Prepare the escort and the escorted crew before getting under way.

Applies / trigger: Before every barge, cargo, fuel-tanker or crew-transfer escort.

Responsible: Escort Team Leader.

Procedure

1. Complete the documented pre-departure risk assessment (SOP-06) and weather Go/No-Go (SOP-07).
2. Deliver an onboarding security and safety briefing to the escorted vessel's crew: route, choke points, comms, emergency signals, muster and man-overboard actions.
3. Confirm shared communications (working channel and emergency signal) between escort and escorted vessel.
4. Agree the escort formation, safe lanes through river bends and narrow channels, and the standoff and speed plan.
5. Record the brief, personnel and vessel details before departure.

Key notes

- The escorted crew must understand the emergency signals before departure.

SOP-12 — Escort — Transit and Perimeter Watch

Purpose: Protect the escorted vessel, cargo and personnel throughout transit.

Applies / trigger: For the duration of every escort.

Responsible: Escort crew.

Procedure

1. Maintain continuous surveillance and a 360-degree perimeter watch on the escorted vessel.
2. Keep the agreed formation and safe lanes; establish and hold safe lanes through bends, narrow channels and high-risk zones.
3. Log all vessel interactions, positions and times accurately as they occur.
4. Challenge and assess any approaching or suspicious craft at a safe standoff; act within the RoE (Annex A).
5. Provide SITREP updates and report any incident immediately per SOP-17.
6. Adjust speed and route for hazards, communities and changing conditions; if conditions become unsafe, seek shelter and report.

Key notes

- The perimeter watch is never left unmanned during transit.

SOP-13 — Escort — Arrival, Debrief and Records

Purpose: Close out the escort and capture lessons.

Applies / trigger: On completion of every escort.

Responsible: Escort Team Leader.

Procedure

1. Confirm the escorted vessel is safely secured at its jetty, anchorage or landing site.
2. Conduct a structured debrief with the team and, where appropriate, the escorted crew.
3. Record vessel interactions, positions, any incidents and lessons learned.
4. Return and account for equipment (SOP-04) and submit the closing SITREP.

Key notes

- Lessons recorded here feed future risk assessments and briefs.

3.5 Boarding, Search and Clearance

SOP-14 — Vessel Boarding, Search and Clearance

Purpose: Board a vessel only for a lawful, authorised purpose and with minimum necessary intrusion.

Applies / trigger: Cargo verification, security inspection, crew verification, threat identification or clearance to proceed.

Responsible: Boarding Officer(s) under Team Leader / MSC authorisation.

Procedure

1. Obtain and record authorisation from the Team Leader or MSC before the boarding commences.
2. Confirm the lawful purpose of the boarding and brief the boarding party on the plan, safety and communications.
3. Wear PPE and body-worn cameras; follow approved safety, communication and personal-protection procedures.
4. Approach and board at a safe point; identify yourselves and state the purpose courteously to the master/crew.
5. Conduct the search or verification with courtesy and the minimum necessary intrusion; treat all persons with dignity.
6. Record who was present, the purpose, the findings and the outcome (clearance granted, held, or escalated).
7. Disembark safely; if a threat or offence is found, contain, report immediately and follow SOP-17 / SOP-22.

Key notes

- No boarding without prior authorisation recorded.
- Boarding is conducted courteously — the objective is verification and clearance, not confrontation.

3.6 Use of Force

SOP-15 — Graduated Use of Force (Rules of Engagement)

Purpose: Ensure any force used is legal, necessary, proportionate and a genuine last resort.

Applies / trigger: Any situation where a threat may require a security response.

Responsible: Every Sea Marshal; overseen by the Team Leader.

Procedure

1. Apply the force continuum in order: professional presence → verbal command and de-escalation → non-lethal control → (only as an absolute last resort in defence of life) lethal force.
2. Exhaust verbal warnings, presence, de-escalation and non-lethal methods before any escalation.
3. Use only the minimum force reasonably necessary and proportionate to the threat.
4. Use lethal force only where there is an imminent threat to life and no lesser means will suffice; where firearms are carried, use them strictly in accordance with PNG law, the licence and the client agreement.
5. Cease force the instant the threat is neutralised.
6. Move immediately to post-incident actions (SOP-16).

Key notes

- The four mandatory tests — legality, necessity, proportionality, non-lethal first — are not subject to local variation.
- Force is a last resort. When in doubt, de-escalate and withdraw to a safe standoff.

SOP-16 — Post Use-of-Force Actions

Purpose: Secure the scene, care for people and account fully for any use of force.

Applies / trigger: Immediately after any use of force, whether or not injury results.

Responsible: Team Leader and personnel involved.

Procedure

1. Make the scene safe and render first aid to any injured person (SOP-20).
2. Report the use of force immediately to the MSC by radio.
3. Preserve evidence: retain body-worn camera footage, note witnesses, positions, times and rounds accounted for.
4. Submit a written use-of-force report within the timeframes in Section 13 of the Policy (SOP-17).
5. Cooperate fully with the ensuing investigation; do not alter or conceal any account or evidence.

Key notes

- Every use-of-force incident is reported and investigated — concealment is a serious offence.

3.7 Incident and Emergency Response

SOP-17 — Incident Classification and Reporting

Purpose: Classify every incident correctly and report it within the required timeline.

Applies / trigger: On any incident.

Responsible: Team Leader; escalated to MSC.

Procedure

1. Classify the incident by level: Level 1 non-threatening; Level 2 suspicious activity or probing; Level 3 hostile boarding, armed confrontation or serious threat to persons; Level 4 fatality, major attack, kidnapping, sabotage or loss of a vessel/major asset.
2. Make an immediate radio report to the MSC on occurrence.
3. Submit a SITREP within 30 minutes of the event stabilising.
4. Submit a written incident report within 12 hours.
5. For Level 2 to Level 4 events, ensure formal investigation and documentation, with client notification where required.

Key notes

- When unsure of the level, classify higher and let the MSC downgrade.
- See Annex B for the incident level and reporting-timeline quick reference.

SOP-18 — Man Overboard (MOB) Recovery

Purpose: Recover a person from the water quickly and safely.

Applies / trigger: Any person in the water.

Responsible: Skipper and crew.

Procedure

1. Shout “Man overboard”, point continuously at the person, and throw a floating aid immediately.
2. The Skipper reduces speed, keeps the person in sight and manoeuvres for recovery, keeping propellers clear.
3. Detail one crew member to maintain visual contact at all times; mark the position on GPS.
4. Recover the person using the approved method and life-saving appliances; begin first aid (SOP-20) as needed.
5. Report to the Operations Room; request SAR (SOP-19) or MEDEVAC (SOP-20) if recovery is delayed or the casualty is injured.
6. Record the event and complete the incident report (SOP-17).

Key notes

- Never lose sight of the person in the water — a dedicated spotter is assigned immediately.

SOP-19 — Search and Rescue (SAR)

Purpose: Coordinate a search and rescue for a missing or distressed person or vessel.

Applies / trigger: Missing person, capsized or distressed vessel, or overdue craft.

Responsible: Team Leader under MSC / Operations Room coordination.

Procedure

1. Activate the Emergency Response Channel and alert the Operations Room and MSC.
2. Establish the last known position, time and conditions; define a search area and pattern.
3. Coordinate with the NMSA, the PNG Defence Force maritime element and other competent authorities as applicable.
4. Conduct the search safely within the vessel's limits and the weather Go/No-Go; log all positions and findings.
5. On location of persons, recover and provide first aid / MEDEVAC (SOP-20); update the Operations Room continuously.
6. Stand down only on the authority of the MSC / coordinating authority; complete the incident report.

Key notes

- Rescuer safety is paramount — do not create a second casualty.

SOP-20 — Medical Emergency and Casualty Evacuation (MEDEVAC)

Purpose: Treat and evacuate an injured or ill person from a remote marine setting.

Applies / trigger: Any injury or medical emergency afloat.

Responsible: Team first-aiders; coordinated by the Team Leader.

Procedure

1. Make the scene safe and begin first aid / CPR as trained; use the team first-aid kit.
2. Activate the Emergency Response Channel; report casualty condition and location to the Operations Room.
3. Prepare for evacuation to the nearest appropriate care; coordinate a receiving point and, where needed, external medical or NMSA support.
4. Move the casualty safely, maintaining care and monitoring throughout transit.
5. Hand over to medical care with a clear condition report; complete the incident report (SOP-17).

Key notes

- All personnel maintain current first aid and CPR competency.

SOP-21 — Fire, Fuel or Cargo Spill Afloat

Purpose: Control a fire or spill and protect people and the environment.

Applies / trigger: Fire aboard, or a fuel/cargo/oil spill.

Responsible: Skipper and crew.

Procedure

1. Raise the alarm; account for all persons and ready life-saving appliances.
2. For fire: cut fuel/power to the source if safe, apply the extinguisher, and prepare to abandon to the water in life jackets if the fire cannot be controlled.
3. For a spill: stop the source if safe, contain where possible, and avoid ignition sources.
4. Report immediately to the Operations Room; request SAR / support as needed.
5. Report the environmental incident without delay (SOP-25) and record the event (SOP-17).

Key notes

- Protection of life comes before protection of the vessel or cargo.

SOP-22 — Hostile Boarding or Armed Approach Response

Purpose: Respond to a hostile boarding attempt, armed approach or serious threat to persons (Level 3/4).

Applies / trigger: Armed robbery, attempted unauthorised boarding, sabotage or armed confrontation.

Responsible: Team Leader and crew.

Procedure

1. Alert the escorted/patrolled vessel, sound the alarm, and transmit an immediate distress/incident report on the ERC and to the MSC.
2. Increase standoff and use vessel manoeuvre, presence and non-lethal deterrence first (Annex A).
3. Employ anti-boarding measures and controlled access; protect personnel and deny unauthorised access.
4. Apply the RoE strictly (SOP-15); use force only as legal, necessary and proportionate, and lethal force only in defence of life.
5. Request rapid-response (SOP-09), joint support (SOP-10) and SAR/MEDEVAC as required.
6. Once safe, secure the scene, preserve evidence, and complete post-incident and reporting actions (SOP-16, SOP-17).

Key notes

- The first objective is to protect life and deter; engagement is the last resort.

SOP-23 — Community Blockade or Landowner Interference

Purpose: De-escalate community or landowner interference lawfully and without escalation.

Applies / trigger: Blockade, obstruction or interference arising from landowner or benefit-sharing disputes.

Responsible: Team Leader.

Procedure

1. Stop at a safe distance; do not force through a blockade or provoke confrontation.
2. Report the situation immediately to the MSC / Operations Room with location and details.
3. Communicate calmly and respectfully; use non-lethal, lawful de-escalation only.
4. Refer the dispute to the appropriate community-liaison channel; do not take sides or negotiate benefit matters.
5. Await instructions; withdraw if remaining would escalate tension or endanger persons.
6. Record the incident promptly and accurately (SOP-17) and log it as a landowner-related event.

Key notes

- Never use security resources to intervene in a community dispute beyond protecting life and assets.
 - Report all landowner-related incidents, however minor.
-

3.8 Community, Environment and Information

SOP-24 — Community Interaction and Grievance Intake

Purpose: Engage respectfully and handle community grievances fairly.

Applies / trigger: Any interaction with, or complaint from, a community member.

Responsible: All personnel; recorded by the Team Leader.

Procedure

1. Treat every person with dignity; respect local customs and land and sea ownership; treat women, children and vulnerable persons with particular care.
2. Avoid any action that provokes or escalates tension; never intimidate, harass or degrade.
3. Receive any complaint respectfully; record it, acknowledge it, and assure the person of no retaliation.
4. Refer the grievance through the Company's grievance mechanism for impartial handling.
5. Report the interaction and grievance to the MSC and log it.

Key notes

- No person raising a grievance in good faith suffers retaliation.
-

SOP-25 — Environmental Incident Response

Purpose: Prevent and respond to pollution in an ecologically sensitive delta and coastal environment.

Applies / trigger: Any actual or potential fuel/oil spill, pollution or environmental harm.

Responsible: Skipper and crew.

Procedure

1. Prevent pollution in normal operations: no fuel/oil spills, responsible waste disposal, respect for fishing grounds and protected areas.
2. On any incident, stop the source if safe and contain where possible (link to SOP-21).

3. Report the environmental incident immediately to the Operations Room / MSC.
4. Support clean-up and follow client and NMSA environmental direction.
5. Record the incident (SOP-17).

Key notes

- Environmental stewardship is a condition of continued operation and protects the Company's and client's reputation.
-

SOP-26 — Confidentiality and Information Handling

Purpose: Protect sensitive operational and client information.

Applies / trigger: At all times, on and off task.

Responsible: All personnel.

Procedure

1. Protect cargo movement schedules, operational routes, communications, client information and any security vulnerabilities.
2. Do not photograph, disclose or disseminate sensitive information; body-worn camera footage is handled only through approved channels.
3. Store and hand over documents and devices securely (SOP-03).
4. Report any suspected loss or unauthorised disclosure to the MSC immediately.

Key notes

- Unauthorised disclosure may be a criminal offence and grounds for dismissal.
 - Report any solicitation, bribe, gift or conflict of interest to the MSC — zero tolerance applies.
-

Annex A — Use of Force / Rules of Engagement Pocket Card

Force is a last resort. Before any escalation, exhaust presence, verbal command and de-escalation, and non-lethal means. Four tests are mandatory and never subject to local variation:

- Legality — force only where permitted by law.
- Necessity — force only when no lawful alternative remains.
- Proportionality — minimum reasonably necessary and proportionate to the threat.
- Non-lethal first — warnings, presence, de-escalation and non-lethal methods before any escalation.

Step	Level	Action
1	Professional presence	Visible, lawful, calm presence to deter.
2	Verbal command / de-escalation	Clear warnings, communication and negotiation.
3	Non-lethal control	Non-lethal methods, standoff and manoeuvre.
4	Lethal force (last resort)	Only where there is an imminent threat to life and no lesser means will suffice; strictly per PNG law and licence. Cease the instant the threat is neutralised.

Every use-of-force incident — whether or not injury results — is reported immediately to the MSC, followed by a written report within the required timeframe, and is investigated.

Annex B — Incident Levels and Reporting Timeline

Level	Description
Level 1	Non-threatening — mechanical issues, minor disturbances, administrative matters.
Level 2	Suspicious activity, attempted approach or probing of a vessel or asset.
Level 3	Hostile boarding attempt, armed confrontation or serious threat to persons.
Level 4	Fatality, major attack, kidnapping, sabotage or loss of a vessel or major asset.

Reporting timeline (all levels)

When	Action
Immediately	Radio report to the MSC on occurrence of any incident.
Within 30 minutes	SITREP submitted after the event stabilises.
Within 12 hours	Written incident report submitted.
Level 2–4	Formal investigation and documentation, with client notification where required.

Annex C — SOP Forms and Records Register

The following records support these SOPs. Each is completed at the point indicated and submitted to the MSC / Operations Room for filing.

Form / Record	Completed at	By
Watch / Patrol Log	SOP-01, 08, 10	Team Leader
Radio / Communications Check Record	SOP-01	Team Leader
SITREP	SOP-02	Team Leader
Shift Handover Record	SOP-03	Team Leaders
Equipment Sign-Out Register	SOP-04	Team member / TL
Vessel Pre-Start Inspection Record	SOP-05	Skipper
Pre-Departure Risk Assessment	SOP-06	Team Leader
Weather / Sea-State Go-No-Go Record	SOP-07	Skipper / TL
Escort Onboarding Brief Record	SOP-11	Team Leader
Boarding & Search Record	SOP-14	Boarding Officer
Use-of-Force Report	SOP-15, 16	Personnel involved
Incident Report	SOP-17 and all emergencies	Team Leader
Community Grievance Record	SOP-24	Team Leader
Environmental Incident Report	SOP-25	Skipper / TL

Annex D — Emergency Contacts and Notification Matrix

Complete the contact details below on issue and keep them current. In any emergency, activate the Emergency Response Channel first.

Contact	Channel / Number	When to notify
Operations Room (ERC)	_____	All incidents / emergencies
Maritime Security Commander (MSC)	_____	All incidents; Level 2–4 immediately
Deputy MSC — Kikori	_____	Routine tasking / Level 1–2
Director of Operations	_____	Level 4 / major events
NMSA (National Maritime Safety Authority)	_____	SAR, safety, maritime authority matters
PNG Defence Force maritime element	_____	Armed threat, SAR support
Client marine / security focal point	_____	Where client notification required
Nearest medical facility	_____	MEDEVAC / casualty
Community Liaison Officer	_____	Landowner / grievance matters

Annex E — Acknowledgement of Receipt and Understanding

I confirm that I have received, read and understood the Sea Marshal Field Standard Operating Procedures (SCSH-SEC-MAR-002 v1.0). I understand that these procedures are issued under the Sea Marshal Security Policy (SCSH-SEC-MAR-001 v2.0), that they must be followed on every task, and that the law of Papua New Guinea, a lawful order and the protection of life take precedence where any conflict arises. I understand that breaches may result in disciplinary action up to termination and referral to the authorities.

Name	
Role / Rank	
Signature	
Date	

Approval and Authorisation

These Standard Operating Procedures are approved for issue and take effect on the date shown in the Document Control table. They are issued under, and read together with, the Sea Marshal Security Policy SCSH-SEC-MAR-001 v2.0 and supersede any previous procedural instructions on the same subject.

Role	Name & Signature	Date
Prepared by — Maritime Security Commander		
Reviewed by — Head of Security Operations		
Approved by — Director of Operations		